ruptcy Bill, for instance, was disposed of in the Grand Committee nearly six weeks ago; and the Government might have so arranged their business as to have sent up this Bill at least a fortnight ago. Lord REDESDALE expressed a very general feeling in the Upper House, when he suggested that Bills which had passed through Grand Committees of the Commons might well be introduced at once into the House of Lords, leaving the final stages in the Lower House to be subsequently taken. It was declared, however, on Ministerial authority, that such a proceeding would be contrary to the usages and rules of Parliament. That may be so, but, at the same time, there may be no good reason why these customs and rule shou'd not be modified by statute. As any change of the kind proposed would affect both Houses, it could hardly be effected by standing orders or rules of procedure passed by the Houses independently; but the passing of an Act of Parliament to meet the case would be practicable. Either in the manner suggested, or in some other, fair play should be given to the Peers in performing their legislative functions; and then, if their Lordships fail, we may reasonably and justly consider some plan of modifying the constitution of their House. But while admitting that their lordships have some ground for alleging an insufficiency of time for the proper examination of all the Bills sent up to them, it would be a misfortune if either of the Bills threatened were wrecked at the stage to which they have reached. They have been very carefully considered in the Lower House, and those peers who take an active part in legislative duties are well aware not only of the principles but of the details of the measures. What amendments they deem advisable the Tory majority can insert without indulging in long debates, and we do not believe they will resort to the extreme course of rejecting either of these measures.

FRIDAY'S ENGAGEMENTS.

Exeter Police Court—11.
St. Thomas Guardians—11.
Exeter Markets.
1st R.V. Camp at Powderham—Athletic Sports.
Theatre Royal—Mr. J. L. Toole and Company.

EXETER CATHEDRAL—SERVICES AND ANTHEMS.

Fri. Morn.—Gilbert E.
Fri. Even.—In Thee, O Lord—Weldon.
Sat. Morn.—King F. To God on High—Mendelssohn.
Sat. Even.—King F. Teach me, O Lord—Attwood (first chorus.)

HIGH WATER AT EXMOUTH BAR.

DATE		MORN.	EVEN.
Friday, August 10th	.. .. ..	10.08	10.48
Saturday, August 11th	.. .. ..	11.8	11.32

Turf, 20 mins. later.

MARRIAGE.

JONES—SANDERS.—August 4, in London, Mr. Herbert Jones, of Kentish Town, to Annie, youngest daughter of the late Mr. John Sanders, of Okehampton.

DEATHS.

DISCOMBE.—August 7, at Helwell Barton, Kenton, Frederick Discombe, aged 25.
GOLDSWORTHY.—August 8, at Magdalen-road, Heavitree, Exeter, Samuel John Goldsworthy, aged 59.
PLYNT.—August 1, at Alphington, Henry Arthur Ernest, son of Henry Plynt, aged 10.
PULSFORD.—August 5, at Ebberley-terrace, Barnstaple, Mary Ann, wife of John Pulsford, aged 63.
STANBURY.—August 8, at St. Michael's Cottage, Worford, John Stanbury, aged 74.
TURNER.—June 12, at Adelaide, South Australia, Jane Turner, late of Alphington, aged 62.

Notices of Births, Marriages, and Deaths must be accompanied with the name and address of the sender.

LOCAL NEWS.

THE *Christian Commonwealth* of August 9th, 1883, gives as a supplement a portrait of the Rev. Thomas M'Cullagh, President of the Wesleyan Conference, now sitting at Hull.

IT is definitely announced that Sir Stafford Northcote will arrive in Belfast on October 2nd. During his visit he will open the Ulster Constitutional Hall, be entertained at a banquet, and address a public meeting.

THE RECHABITE CONFERENCE.—We learn by telegram that at this morning's sitting of the above Conference, which is being held at Douglas, Isle of Man, it was resolved to hold the Conference for 1885 at Exeter. Bro. J. H. Caseley, who is attending as the representative of the Exeter District (of which the Bishop has recently been initiated a member) was elected a member of the Board of Directors for the ensuing two years.

WE have received a copy of the current number of "The Church in Cornwall," the principal feature of which is an interesting paper by Mr. F. E. Sach, Superintendent of the Christ Church Boys' School, Plymouth. It bears the title of "Our ideal," being an address to Sunday School teachers, and was read by the author to a large gathering of Sunday School Teachers, at St. Austell last month. Persons engaged in the responsible duty of religiously instructing the young will find a perusal of Mr. Sach's paper a profitable employment of time.

THE 1ST R V. CAMP.—More agreeable weather has been experienced to-day, the brilliant sunshine being tempered by a strong westerly breeze. To-day's work has again been of a satisfactory nature, the muster being a more numerous one than is generally experienced after the expiration of the fourth day, when there is usually a large exodus of "four-day men," as they are known—men who, from the exigencies of business, are unable to complete the whole week in camp. The drill-competition for the Mayor's Cup is fixed for five o'clock this afternoon. It is hardly creditable to the members of A and B Companies that they cannot muster sufficient to entitle them to compete—viz., 18 files—but for this, of course, the officers are not responsible, the onus resting with the members themselves. The College Company may not be fully represented in the matter of non-commissioned officers, but there is naturally an allowance to be made in their case. Under these circumstances, the competition will be reduced to a match between C and D Companies (commanded respectively by Capts. Mortimer and Richards), and nobody doubts that the tussle will be a hard one. Major Hillyard (3rd D.R.V.) will officiate as umpire. The judging-distance prizes were announced this morning, the results being as follows:—A Company—Pte. Cox, 15s., 10 points; Pte. Manley, 12s. 6d., 9 points; Pte. Searle, 10s., 8 points. B Company—Pte. Smith, 15s., 10 points; Pte. Pearse, 12s. 6d., 9 points; Pte. Ware, 7s. 6d., 7 points. C Company—Pte. Tremayne, 10s., 8 points; Pte. Perry, 7s. 6d., 7 points. D Company—Sgt. Hole, 10s., 8 points; Pte. Parr, 7s. 6d., 7 points. E Company—Pte. Dawe, 7s. 6d., 7 points; Pte. Williams, 7s. 6d., 7 points. F and H Companies, nil. I—Pte. Gilpin, 7s. 6d., 7 points; Pte. Birch, 7s. 6d., 7 points. A separate competition will probably be provided for those men who were on guard on the day of the competition.

POLICE NEWS.

Exeter—This Day.

Before the Mayor (Mr. S. Jones), and Messrs. T. Andrew (ex-Mayor,) and W. Buckingham.

ABUSE.

John Waldron, a fish dealer, was summoned for using abusive language towards Miriam Lee, in Coombe-street, on the 6th inst. Mr. Friend appeared for the complainant, and he stated that the language was abominably filthy. This statement was corroborated by the complainant. The defendant admitted the offence, and said he was very sorry. This was his first offence. The Bench fined him 7s. 6d. and the expenses, or seven days' imprisonment.

Torquay—This Day.

Before Messrs. W. B. Fortescue (chairman), W. Bridges, and W. F. Splatt.

Mr. Hext, solicitor, applied on behalf of Mrs. Rolph for a license to sell liquors in the camp field of the Rifle Volunteers on Saturday next. The Bench granted a licence for Friday and Saturday, the Chairman saying that as one day of the previous license had not expired, a two days' license was granted.

Robert Gale, stone cutter, was summoned for being drunk and disorderly in Temperance-street, yesterday, at 12 a.m. P.C. Gregory proved the case, and a fine of 10s. including costs, or, in default, 7 days' imprisonment was imposed.

John Stone, labourer, was summoned for being found drunk on the 4th inst., in St. Mary Church Road. P.C. Bond proved the case, and a fine of 6s. 6d. inclusive was imposed.

Bessie Stephens, an old offender, pleaded guilty to being found drunk in Castle-steps on the 5th August. P.C. Way proved the case. Fined 15s. or fourteen days' imprisonment. Defendant went to prison.

George Parratt was charged with travelling without a ticket on the 8th inst. George Rollin, station-master at Torre, stated that the defendant arrived by the 3.15 train, and on attempting to go out, in giving up his ticket, tendered a portion of a booth or racing ticket. He was told to stand aside, and after the passengers had gone out he was again asked, and as the ticket-collector could get nothing out of him, the matter was referred to witness, who, after questioning the defendant for upwards of an hour, could get nothing out of him. Witness then sent for a constable, who tried to get his ticket or something sensible out of him, but with no success. He was then taken to the station. Dr. Gordon Cumming stated that he examined the defendant; he was talking irrationally, and it was his opinion that he was suffering from the effects of drink. He could give no satisfactory account of himself, or a bruise which he had under his right eye. He was evidently not a responsible person, and he should be watched. A fine of £2 was imposed, but as it was found that he had no money, he was sent to prison for fourteen days.

BARNSTAPLE.

An inquest on the body of Alice Maud Shaw, aged 13 months, was held by the borough coroner (Mr. Bencraft) on Wednesday, at 14, Newport Terrace. It appeared from the evidence of the witnesses that on Sunday morning, about eleven o'clock, the child was sitting in a high chair at a table in the kitchen, having just had its breakfast. The servant girl, Florence Richards, was preparing the child's bath, and had just put about three quarts of boiling water into the bath. She went into the scullery to fetch some cold water, and while there she heard a noise as though the child was falling. She ran into the kitchen and found that the child had fallen into the bath of hot water. She ran and called her mistress, who sent her for Dr. Cooke, whom she found at the Infirmary. On arriving, the medical gentleman found that the child's left arm and shoulder and right hand were severely scalded, and that the fall had caused insensibility. The child gradually sank, and died about twelve o'clock on the following night. A verdict of "Accidental Death" was returned.

ASSAULTING THE MAYOR'S SON.—At the Guildhall on Wednesday, before Mr. J. M. Miller (in the chair) and Mr. C. Crasweller, *Alfred Drew*, shoemaker, was summoned for being drunk and disorderly in the Square on the previous day, and with assaulting Henry Ashton, son of the Mayor. Henry Ashton stated that yesterday morning the defendant came to his father's house, and asked to see the Mayor. On being told that he was not at home, prisoner became very abusive, saying he was a ratepayer, and had as much right to see the Mayor as any other b——. Witness ordered him off, whereupon prisoner struck him a blow in the face, and would have done so again had it not been for Mr. Whitfield, who kept the prisoner from him. Witness then called P.C. McLeod, but on prisoner seeing the policeman he moved off. P.C. McLeod gave evidence to the effect that he saw the prisoner making a disturbance outside the Mayor's house, but did not see him strike any blows, though he saw a red mark on the last witness's face. Prisoner was mad drunk. Mr. W. P. Bencraft, who appeared for the prisoner, asked the Bench to be as lenient as possible with the prisoner, as he had been a total abstainer for fourteen months until within the last week or two. The Mayor (Mr. R. Ashton) stated that he did not wish the Bench to be severe with the prisoner. The Bench fined him 10s. and costs for each offence, allowing him a week to pay.

OTTERY ST. MARY.

On Saturday last a number of the employés of Mr. E. Carnell, builder, of this town, held their annual wayzgoose, numbering over fifty. Leaving here in the early morning, they drove to Seaton, visiting Beer and other places of interest. A good substantial dinner was served by Host Fewings, of the Pole Arms. The chair was taken by Mr. E. Carnell, the vice-chair by Mr. G. Fisher. The usual toasts were proposed and responded to, and a most harmonious day was spent, and all returned thoroughly well pleased with their day's enjoyment. Great credit is due to Messrs. Dunn and Meldon for the capital arrangement of the programme.

CHAGFORD.

The children attending the National School were recently examined by Her Majesty's Inspector (Mr. H. F. Codd), and the report shows that both teachers and scholars have acquitted themselves well. The merit grant of 2s. per head on the average attendance was awarded, and the full grant allowed by the Education Department for class subjects (English and geography), and was earned. The report states "both discipline and instruction are good, and the state of the school still continues to be most satisfactory." The total amount of grant earned was £141 6s. 10d., making 18s. 6½d. per head, the full amount of grant which the managers can claim being 17s. 6d. per head on the average attendance. The master received the following endorsement on his certificate:—"The state of this school still continues to reflect great credit on Mr. Smith." The children in the Infant School have also passed a most successful examination, and the school is classed "good."

DAWLISH.

SUICIDE OF A YOUNG WOMAN.—Mr. S. Hacker held an inquest at the Cottage Hospital, Dawlish, yesterday, touching the death of Mary Margaret Louisa Compton, who was drowned at Dawlish on Monday. William Johns and Anne Evers, who were sitting on a seat under the railway station platform, said that about 9 20 on Monday night they observed some person walk towards the sands, and then into the water. The figure soon disappeared, and they saw something moving and floating, but the water there was not deep. A man named Pike then accompanied Johns to the water's edge, and the waves gradually brought the object therein closer, when Johns, holding by Pike, walked out and brought in the body. They both tried to restore animation. The young woman was without a bonnet. Charles Henry Piesse, of London, public analyst and medical practitioner, staying at Blenheim House, stated that the deceased, who had been in his service for seven weeks, was just recovering from malarial fever; she had seemed at times absent-minded, and brooding, and suffering from hallucinations. She was missed from their lodgings soon after 9 p.m. on the night in question, and on inquiry he found that the body at the Cottage Hospital was that of his servant. Mr. Parsons, surgeon, said that on arriving at the beach he found that the deceased was dead. Knowing that artificial respiration had been tried, he ordered the body to be taken first to the Albert and then to the Royal Hotel, but the proprietors declined to take it in. From the evidence of Dr. Piesse, he considered the deceased was not in her right mind. Margaret Compton, mother of deceased, and residing at Hornchurch, Essex, said the deceased was 26 years of age. Witness produced a letter from deceased. P.C. Stapleton stated that on his arrival at the beach he tried artificial respiration. Deceased had on her spectacles. The Coroner, in summing up the evidence, remarked on the unwillingness of the two hotel-keepers to take in the body. Although it was not a settled point of law that they were bound to do so, he thought, from a moral point of view, they might have received the deceased. In a place like Dawlish there ought to be a public mortuary. The jury returned a verdict to the effect that deceased "committed suicide whilst in a state of temporary insanity." The jury gave their fees to deceased's mother.

TORQUAY.

THE CLIFF QUESTION.—Another meeting in connection with the above question was held in the Banner Cross Room last evening, Mr. Farrell presiding. Mr. Cliff, the ex-member of the Blue Ribbon Committee, moved, "That this meeting regards the temperance work of such importance that nothing short of the united efforts of all temperance workers will be effectual to grapple with the evil of intemperance." This was seconded by Mr. Gunn, a member of the Blue Ribbon Committee, who said that the Rev. Canon Wilberforce had written to the Rev. J. Hewett, deeply regretting the action of the Committee; but in view that the Unitarians had commenced the fight, they had better carry it on. After some discussion the resolution was withdrawn, and Mr. R. Butland moved and Mr. Cliff seconded, "That a public meeting of the temperance party in Torquay be called to consider the action of the committee and move resolutions thereon," which was carried unanimously.

LIBELLING A CORONER.

At Norwich Assizes yesterday, before Lord Justice Baggallay, Mr. Wilkin, solicitor, of King's Lynn, and county coroner, brought an action against Mr. John Gardiner, printer and publisher of the *Wisbeach Advertiser*, for libel. An inquest on the body of a man drowned in the river Nene whilst bathing was delayed by the coroner until information was afforded him of the precise locality of the fatality. The body was in a state of putrefaction, and the delay in issuing a warrant for burial compelled the widow and her five children to leave the house, so great was the stench. The *Advertiser* denounced the action of the coroner as a great public scandal. The defence was justification. The jury found for the plaintiff, damages £150.

THE new family Match Safe for Bryant and May's Patent Safety Matches, supplies a want that has long been felt, and will be adopted at once by all careful housekeepers. It is very ornamental, and contains three dozen boxes of Bryant and May's Patent Safety Matches and three of the metal cases, and can be obtained from any grocer or oilman, filled and fitted complete for 2s. 6d. It is strong, and damp proof, and should be found in every store room.—Advt.

FATAL BOATING ACCIDENTS.

A sad disaster has befallen five men of South Shields, named Joseph Forster, John Roper, Andrew Coulson, James Milner, and Joseph Wilson. They left South Shields in a pleasure boat under sail, and a short distance out the boat capsized, and the whole of the men were drowned. The boat was picked up by a steamer, and taken to Sunderland. Most of the deceased were married and had families.

The Wick fishing fleet was caught in a severe gale yesterday afternoon, and serious fears were entertained as to their safety, but by evening nearly all the boats had arrived in safety. One boat, however, belonging to John Mackay Cormack, was swamped off the Caithness coast, and her crew of six men were drowned. A Lossiemouth boat was wrecked in the estuary at Wick, but her occupants were rescued.

MYSTERIOUS OCCURRENCES.

The body of a carman, named William Smith, residing at Woodside, near Croydon, has been found lying in the road near his house. The head of the deceased was battered in, his back injured, and several ribs broken. The injuries shew that the unfortunate man was either murderously assaulted, or run over whilst returning home under the influence of drink on Monday night.—The deputy-coroner for East Middlesex held an inquest at Hackney yesterday on Charles Henry Bear, aged 9 years. The deceased left his home at Old Ford on Wednesday in last week for Epping Forest. He was seen fishing in the river Lea, and was afterwards missed. On Sunday his body was found in the river, with a fishing line twisted round his left wrist, and also round his neck. Foul play was suspected, but medical evidence was to the effect that there were no external marks of violence. The jury returned an open verdict.

COLLISION IN THE CHANNEL.

It was reported at Dover yesterday by the captain of the Ramsgate passenger boat, the *Queen of Thanet*, that a large full-rigged ship had sunk in the Channel about 11 miles from Dover, and near the Varne bank, and that with the exception of one man all hands were supposed to have gone down with the ship. All day it had been blowing a gale from the south-west, and the sea in the Channel, especially in mid-Channel, had been very high. The *Queen of Thanet* left Ramsgate in the morning, and was crossing with passengers to Boulogne. About mid-day two large vessels were noticed in the vicinity of the Varne lightship, one a full-rigged ship coming up Channel and the other a barque going down. Nothing unusual was noticed until the larger vessel of the two was seen to make two lurches, and then suddenly she disappeared. The whole occurrence was the work of a few instants. No actual collision was seen, but it is supposed that this was the cause of the catastrophe. The captain of the *Queen of Thanet* steamed to the spot, and the boats were got in readiness to be launched. While the steamer was approaching in a very heavy sea, one man was seen in a canoe, but he was picked up by the *Taige*, which proceeded down Channel before the steamer could come up with her. On the information being received at Dover, the harbour tug, *Lady Vita* (Captain Manser) at once proceeded to the scene of the catastrophe, but found nothing beyond a vast quantity of wreckage.

It subsequently appeared that the vessels in collision were the *Speranza*, barque, of Tvestrand, Norway, 474 tons burden, with timber, for Liverpool, and the barque *Erstatnangen*, 380 tons, of the same place, with coals from Newcastle for Santos. The vessel which sank was the *Erstatnangen*. Both vessels were proceeding down Channel on different tacks, there being a strong wind at the time and a heavy sea running. At the time of the collision the *Erstatnangen* was on the starboard tack. The other vessel, whose duty it was to have made way for her, was noticed to be bearing down on the *Erstatnangen* for some time before the collision occurred, and as she drew nearer, signals were made to her; but she did not alter her course, the result being that she struck the *Erstatnangen* on the port side, close to the forerigging, with great force, making a large breach in her side, extending below the water-line. The *Erstatnangen* sank almost immediately. While the vessels were in contact, the crew, with the exception of one man, clambered up the bows of the *Speranza*; the other man was afterwards picked up, as reported, by the captain of the Ramsgate steamer, but the crew saved none of their effects. The *Speranza* landed the crew of the sunken vessel at Deal.

TERRIBLE TRAGEDY AT WALTHAMSTOW.

FIVE CHILDREN MURDERED.

About half-past five or six o'clock last evening, a most distressing and horrible tragedy was perpetrated at St. James's-street, Walthamstow, a blacksmith, named Gouldstone, having drowned three of his children—Charles, aged three years and-a-half, Herbert, aged two years and a-half, and Frederick, aged sixteen months; and so seriously assaulted another two twin boys, aged but seven days—that both have since died.

Gouldstone, it seems, is a blacksmith in the employ of a firm carrying on business in Lower Thames-street, City, and he has been engaged there for five years. Last night he returned home earlier than usual, and seemed to be in rather a strange temper. He called to a woman who was nursing Mrs. Gouldstone—the latter having given birth to twins only a week since—to bring him his son Frederick, aged 16 months. The little chap, just able to toddle along, went willingly to his father, and laughed at him, unconscious of the fate in store for him. Having kissed and caressed the boy, Gouldstone called the nurse, and said that as he wanted to speak to his wife on a private matter concerning the payment of the doctor's fees, he asked her to leave the room, and she did so. Presently she ran back hurriedly, for she heard a splash of water, and, going to the cistern, which she saw was running over, she was shocked to see therein the bodies of Mr. Gouldstone's three sons—Frederick, aged sixteen months, Herbert, aged two and a half years; and Charles, aged three and a half years. She lost no time in taking them out of the water, but she had hardly done so before she heard Mrs. Gouldstone screaming in her bedroom. The nurse, now thoroughly affrighted, went at once to the door, but found that it was fastened from the inside. She then screamed out for help, and a lady residing close by went into the house, and by their united efforts the door of the bedroom was burst open. The father stood with a hammer in his hand, and, suspecting what had occurred, the nurse exclaimed, "Why, what have you done?" The father answered, "Now I am happy; she is a single woman." By this time Sergeant Smith, of the N division, with some policemen, had arrived on the scene, and removing the bodies of the three drowned children to the mortuary, they sent for a doctor, who pronounced that the infant twins were not dead, but it was only a question of time, for the injuries they received were sure to cause their death. This proved to be true—one of the infants died an hour or so later, and the other succumbed at about eleven o'clock last night. The mother at this time appeared to be in a dying state, though hopes are entertained that she will recover from the shock caused by the fearful double murder that was perpetrated before her eyes. Various speculations are rife as to the cause of the terrible tragedy, none being of a satisfactory nature; but, from the fact that the prisoner, since his wife's last confinement, has not spoken more than a dozen words to her, it may be inferred that during that time he had had something weighing heavily on his mind. Superintendent Green and Inspectors Craggs and Foulkard, of the N division, were quickly on the spot investigating the sad tragedy. The prisoner was taken to the Leabridge-road Police-station.

[BY TELEGRAPH.]

THE MURDERER COMMITTED FOR TRIAL.

William Gouldstone, the blacksmith, who last night drowned his three children in a cistern, at Walthamstow, was to-day brought before the magistrates charged with wilful murder. The other infants whom he struck with a hammer have died. Ada Hamilton, nurse, detailed the facts of the case as stated above, and said prisoner was not unkind to the children, but appeared strange after the twins were born. Prisoner was remanded.

THE Parliamentary papers issued yesterday included the estimate for the expenses of Greenwich Hospital and School for the year ending March 31st, 1884. The amount required is £154 332, less than the previous year's estimate by £1,125. This sum is disposed of as follows: Official expenses of Greenwich Hospital, £5 581; pensions, gratuities, &c., £119,682; expenses of Greenwich Hospital School, £29,069.

CRUEL ASSAULT.—A man named Stroud was, at Ramsgate, yesterday, sentenced to four months' hard labour, and bound over in the sum of £20 to keep the peace for six months after the expiration of the term, for committing a cruel assault on a woman named Deverson. It was alleged that he continued to beat her for three hours, and ended in throwing her out of window, causing her to fall a distance of 12ft.

THE SABBATARIAN RIOTS AT STROME FERRY.

The agitation throughout Scotland in favour of the release from prison of the Strome Ferry fishermen convicted of rioting is extending. Several presbyteries have petitioned the Home Secretary, and on Wednesday at Edinburgh the Commission of the Free Church agreed to memorialise Sir W. Harcourt to reconsider the case and mitigate the sentence. The memorialists express a feeling at the same time that means should be taken to secure the application of the law of the land in regard to the Sabbath to labour on the railways, as well as labour of all other descriptions. Dr. Begg, who moved this resolution, said he thought they should, if necessary, even approach the Queen herself on the matter. He had visited the men in prison, and had found them being treated as common felons. Their hair was cropped, and they were wearing prison garb. (Cries of "Shame.") Principal Rainy seconded the motion, and it was adopted by the Commission of Assembly, which is the Supreme Court of the Church. The Commission intend to petition Parliament to hand over the superintendence of education in Scotland to the proposed Local Government Board.

FORESTERS' HIGH COURT.

YESTERDAY'S PROCEEDINGS.

The third sitting of the High Court meeting of Foresters was held on Wednesday in the Townhall, Birmingham, the High Chief Ranger (Mr. Girling, of Birmingham) presiding. The Parliamentary agent's report gave rise to a somewhat excited discussion. It contained a paragraph expressing regret that the Dublin district committed what he considered a false step when they circulated documents amongst courts of the Order suggesting that they should petition Parliament against Mr. Gray's committal for contempt of court.—Mr. BLAKE, however, withdrew the paragraph, and observed that he did not desire to inflict a second punishment on the Irish brethren.—Mr. COLLINS (Dublin) warmly protested against a gratuitous insult, and after some animated discussion and loud cheering, Mr. BLAKE withdrew the objectionable phrase, and ended what threatened to be an angry scene.—On thirty guineas being proposed to be granted to Mr. Blake for his services, Mr. MCDONOUGH (Dublin) moved that the sum should be reduced to £10, and complained that the Parliamentary agent did not render satisfactory assistance to secure Irish Courts being excluded from the operations of the Crimes Act.—Mr. ADAMS (London) seconded the amendment, on the ground that he considered £10 would be adequate for the services rendered.—Mr. BLAKE explained the efforts he had made, which ended in the desired result being obtained, and the amendment was withdrawn.—A second amendment was moved, however, for granting £20, and on this a division was taken, which resulted in its rejection by 317 against 82 votes. The original proposition was then adopted, with only six dissentients, and Mr. Blake was unanimously re-elected Parliamentary agent for the ensuing year.

The Superannuation Committee's report, one of the most important questions for consideration, was next discussed. The committee recommended a general fund for the entire Order, controlled by the Executive Committee, because the funds could be more readily and advantageously invested, and the scheme might be immediately adopted. They recommended the establishment of a general fund on a 4 per cent. basis for assuring an annuity of 5s. per week to commence at 65 years of age. Had they suggested 60 years for the commencement of the annuity, the contributions would have been so high that only very few members could possibly have secured annuities. Provision had also been made for enabling existing members to contribute for the annuity as an extra benefit, and to facilitate this being done tables of contributions had also been prepared for enabling sick benefits after 65 to be converted into an annuity. It was left, however, entirely optional with members whether they would insure annuities.—Mr. SQUIRE (Nottingham), as chairman of the committee, moved the adoption of the scheme, and explained some of the provisions named. Notwithstanding the onslaught made by the valuer of a kindred society, who declared that 3 per cent. was the utmost that could be secured by friendly societies for invested funds, no difficulty had been experienced in realising 4 per cent. on the High Court capital, and therefore that had been unhesitatingly adopted. They had perfect confidence in the soundness and stability of the projected fund, and that there would be a surplus equal to any possible contingency. He moved the adoption of the report, and that the incoming Executive Council should be directed to prepare the necessary alterations of the general laws for the approval of the next High Court meeting.—Mr. RADLEY (London) seconded the proposition.—Mr. DIGHT (Birmingham) objected to the scheme being optional, but was told that that was an express instruction to the committee.—Mr. GRAY (Waltham) moved, and Mr. CALDWELL (Hereford) seconded, an amendment affirming that no scheme could be regarded as satisfactory which required contributions beyond the means of the bulk of members. Mr. Caldwell suggested that some provision should be made for returning relatives some portion of the premiums paid when a member died.

At mid-day, before the discussion closed, the High Court adjourned, and the delegates proceeded by special train to Warwick, where they were shewn through the Castle and other places of interest in the neighbourhood.

IMPERIAL PARLIAMENT.

HOUSE OF COMMONS—YESTERDAY.

CETEWAYO'S REPORTED DEATH.

Mr. ASHLEY informed Mr. R. Fowler that the only information received at the Colonial Office respecting the reported safety of Cetewayo was a telegram stating that Mr. Finn, the resident with Cetewayo, had had a message purporting to come from Cetewayo, to the effect that he was alive. Mr. Osborne, the British Resident in the reserved territory, entertained doubts as to its accuracy, but Mr. Robinson, a missionary, thought it was true. Replying to a further question, the hon. gentleman explained that, at the request of the home Government, Sir H. Bulwer had communicated to them the conditions on which Langalibalele could be safely restored, and that these conditions had been submitted to the Legislative Council.

THE CORRUPT PRACTICES BILL.

On the order for the consideration of the Corrupt Practices Bill as amended, Mr. WARTON moved to recommit the measure with the view of increasing the maximum amount of expenditure which candidates for borough constituencies might incur.—This was opposed by the ATTORNEY-GENERAL, and was negatived without a division.—A proviso, moved by Mr. M. D. SCOTT, to exclude from the category of corrupt practices the exercise of ordinary hospitality with corrupt motive, was opposed by the ATTORNEY-GENERAL as being unnecessary, and was rejected on a division by 85 to 38.—A proposal by Mr. HEALY to include specially among corrupt practices threats of legal process made with the view of influencing the votes of electors were objected to on the same ground, and was negatived by 131 to 28.—An amendment, moved by Mr. RAIKES to omit the perpetual disqualification of a candidate personally guilty of corrupt practices from sitting for the constituency in which such practices were committed, in order to substitute a limited disqualification extending over that Parliament and seven years subsequently, was negatived by 118 to 61.—Some further amendments were disposed of, but the stage had not been concluded when the time arrived at which, by the rules of the House, the further consideration of the measure was adjourned.

THE HEALTH OF TROOPS IN EGYPT.

Sir A. HAYTER, at the instance of Viscount Folkestone, read a telegram received that day from the General Commanding the British Forces in Egypt, stating that the improvement in the health of the troops was progressing at all the stations.—The House adjourned at five minutes to six o'clock.

SECOND EDITION.

LATEST NEWS.

LONDON AND SOUTH-WESTERN RAILWAY COMPANY.

HALF-YEARLY MEETING—TO-DAY.

[SPECIAL TELEGRAM.]

At the South-Western half-yearly meeting held to-day Mr. R. Dutton (Chairman) presiding, the balance-sheet and report were adopted, and a dividend of 4¾ per cent. declared payable on the 16th August. Resolutions were adopted approving special matters, namely, the working agreements with the North Cornwall Railway, transfer of the Plymouth and Dartmouth Railway to their Company, and the issue of £130,000 debenture stock. Mr. Dutton having answered enquiries made by some shareholders, the meeting concluded with a vote of thanks to the Chairman.

(PER "CENTRAL NEWS.")

Lord Dufferin returns to Constantinople in October.

THE RISING IN SPAIN.

REVOLT OF ANOTHER REGIMENT.

DISTURBANCES AT BARCELONA.

A *Daily News'* Madrid telegram of to-day says:—A Cavalry Regiment at Santo Domingo de la Calzada, near Logroño, rose in rebellion early yesterday morning, and quitted the town under the leadership of a lieutenant and several sergeants. The other officers of the regiment endeavoured to induce the troops to return to their duty. The gravity of this news is increased by the fact that armed bands of the working classes have created disturbances near Barcelona. The rioters fled before the troops.

FENIAN TRIALS AT LIVERPOOL.

The trial of the four dynamitors was proceeded with at Liverpool to-day, the fifth prisoner, Otterliby, having, by the judge's direction, been acquitted last night. Dr. Commins addressed the Court for Deasy, and other Counsel followed. The case is expected to conclude to-day.

BRISTOL CORN MARKET.

The weather was beautifully fine and there was a fair attendance at the market to-day. English wheat nominal. A fair trade doing in foreign at 1s. advance. Barley at about last week's prices. Maize 6d. dearer. Oats firm at late rates.

BRISTOL CATTLE MARKET.

The supply of beef was moderate, but was enough for trade demands, probably through States cattle having been sold early in the week. Best qualities fetched 82s to 84s.; secondary, 78s. There was a large supply of sheep and lambs, trade being quiet. Best sheep realised 9½d.; secondary, 9d.; lamb, 10½d. to 11d. 500 pigs were on offer. Bacon obtained 11s. 6d.; porkers, 11s. 6d. to 11s. 9d. A slow trade was done in store cattle through high prices.

LONDON CATTLE MARKET.

There were 850 beasts, including 410 foreign, at the market to-day; trade being firmer, at 4s 2d to 6s 2d. Also 5,250 sheep, including 1,130 foreign. Trade steadier, at 5s 4d to 7s. Sixty calves made from 5s 8d to 6s 6d, and ten pigs from 4s 4d to 5s per 8lbs.

BRIGHTON RACES

Kempton Plate.—Navigius, 1; Gloriana, 2; Vansire, 3. Three ran. Betting on race: 4 to 1 on Navigius, 8 to 1 agst. each Gloriana and Vansire. Navigius jumped off in front, and made all the running, and won by three parts of a length. Bad third. Winner was bought in for 250 guineas.

Preston Handicap.—Gareth, 1; Canon, 2; Jack-in-Green, 3. Eight ran. Betting on race: 11 to 8 agst Brag, 100 to 30 agst Fiery Cross, 4 to 1 agst Canon, 10 to 1 agst Gareth. Fiery Cross made play from Staffa, with Canon and Gareth next to the distance, when the latter came away and won by five lengths. Bad third. Staffa fourth and Fiery Cross next.

POLLARD AND ELDRIDGE
STOCK AND SHARE BROKERS,
CITY CHAMBERS, GANDY-ST.,
EXETER.
COUPONS CASHED FREE OF CHARGE

COMMERCIAL INTELLIGENCE.

SPECIAL MONEY ARTICLE.

[PER "PRESS ASSOCIATION."]

LONDON, Two p.m.

The discount demand is more active, and rates are still firmer at 3¾—⅞ for first-class acceptances. Short Loans are in moderate request, at 3¼ per cent. Indian Exchanges unaltered.

There is not much business doing on the Stock Exchange, and prices exhibit but little change since twelve o'clock. Consols remain 100⅛—¼ for Account. New and Reduced, 100⅛—¼.

A further fall of ½ has taken place in Spanish to 59¼—⅜. Egyptians also dull. Unified, 71⅛—⅜. Daira Loan, 70⅝—⅞. Domain, 92¾—3. '71 Tribute Loan, 72¾—3. Defence, 86—¼. Turkish Fives, 10⅛—¼. Mexicans firm, about 29. Peru Fives, 11⅝—⅞.

In Home Rails, Easterns at 71—¼, British at 104—¼, and Westerns at 140⅜—⅝, are fractionally better. Southern Lines steady. Brighton Deferred, 115⅜—⅝. South Eastern Deferred, 113⅛—⅜.

Americans continue flat. York Centrals, 118¼—¾. Wabash Preference, 36¼—¾. Denvers, 35¼—¾. Lake Shores, 100—½. Ontarios, 22⅝—⅞. Canadians firm. Trunk Preferences rather better; Seconds, 39—½; Thirds, 43. Mexican Rails have fallen ½ to 115—½.

Native Guano Shares dull, 3⅛—¼. Hudson's Bays unaltered.

Brush Lights dull, 3⅛—¼.

Telegraphs quiet. Telephones, 8⅜—⅝.

Brighton Railway yesterday's passenger traffic, £585 increase.

Lombardo-Venetian Railway week's traffic shows an increase of a thousand florins.

Paris Bourse weak. Spanish depressed.

(PER "CENTRAL NEWS.")

12 o'Clock.—Bank-rate unaltered. Mexican Railways, 115¼. Markets quiet. Spanish very dull.

3.—Markets quiet.

TO-DAY'S STOCK EXCHANGE QUOTATIONS

Description of Stock.	Issue.	Yesterday's Closing Prices.	Noon Prices To-day	Closing Prices 3 o'clock
Consols	3 p.c.	100 1-16	..	..
Do. Account	"	100 5-16	...	100 3-16
Do. New and Reduced ..	"	100 3-16	..	...
BRITISH RAILWAYS.				
Caledonian..	Ord.	105¼	105⅜	105¼
East London	"	24	..	..
Great Eastern	"	70	..	70⅝
Great North of Scotland	"	59	..	–
Great Northern	"	115	..	..
" "	"	109¼	..	109⅜
Great Western	"	140¼	14 ⅜	140⅜
Lancashire & Yorkshire ..	"	118⅝	–	..
L. Brighton & South Coast	"	123	..	
" "	A	115¼	115⅜	115⅜
L. Chatham and Dover	Ord	25⅜	..	..
" "	Pref.	1.2⅝	..	..
London & North Western	Ord.	177	177¼	177¼
London & South Western	"	120¼	..	–
Man. Shef. and Lincoln	"	86¾ xd	...	..
" "	Def.	49	49¼	49⅝
Metropolitan	Ord.	126⅝	..	..
Do. District	"	56¼	...	..
Midland	"	137¼	..	...
North British	"	104½	..	..
North Eastern	"	174	..	..
North Staffordshire		88⅜	..	..
South Eastern		124	–	..
" "	Def.	113⅛	113⅜	113⅜
COLONIAL RAILWAYS.				
Grand Trunk, Canada	Ord.	17¾	17⅞	17¾
Do. 1st Pref. ..	Pref.	101⅜	..	..
Do. 2nd Pref. ..	"	88¼	89	88¾
Do. 3rd Pref. ..	"	42⅜	42⅝	42¾
Great Western of Canada	Ord.	14¼	..	...
New York Lake Erie & Western		35	34⅝	34⅝
do. do	2nd Mrt.	97⅜	..	–
N.Y. Pennsyl. & Ohio	1st Mrt.	45⅛	45	..
do. do.	2nd Mrt.	11⅝	12	..
do. do.	3rd Mrt.	5⅜	5⅜	..
Pennsylvania Railway		59⅝	..	59⅝
Philadelphia and Reading		28¾	..	...
FOREIGN BONDS.				
Lombards	Ord.	13⅜	..	..
Egyptian Railway Loan	6%	93⅞	..	93⅜
Do. Unified Debt	5%	72	71 11-16	71 11-16
Do. State Domain	5%	93	92¾	..
Do. Daira Sanieh	5%	70⅝	70⅝	70¾
French Rentes	5%	109⅜	109⅜	109⅜
Hungarian (4%) Gold	1874	74⅝	..	..
Italian	5%	89⅜	...	..
Mexican	3%	29	..	..
Peru (6%)	1870	16⅜	..	15⅜
Do. (5%)	1872	11⅜	..	...
Russian (5%)	1870	87 xd	..	..
" (5%)	1873	86⅜	...	..
" (4½%)	1875	9⅜		..
[illegible]	4%	61 9-16	60	59⅝
[illegible]	2%	14⅛	..	..
Turkish (5%)	1865	10 11-16	..	10⅝
Do. [illegible]	1869	11 9-16	..	..
Do. Tribute	1869	73	72¾	..
United States	Funded	1 4	..	..
BANK.				
Imperial Ottoman Bank..	..	19 7-16	..	19 5-16

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